



IB DP PARENT HANDBOOK

Súkromné gymnázium, Česká 10

Purpose This handbook gives parents and legal guardians a concise overview of the Diploma Programme and the school's key policies. Full policies, current calendars and official IB regulations remain authoritative.

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How to use this handbook

- Use this handbook for a quick explanation of the school's expectations and procedures.
- Use the full policy when exact definitions, evidence requirements, sanctions, application forms or appeal procedures are needed.
- Always follow the current school deadline calendar and communications, as dates may change during the year.

1. The Diploma Programme at a glance

At a glance The DP is a rigorous two-year programme for students aged 16–19. It combines six academic subjects with Theory of Knowledge, the Extended Essay and Creativity, Activity, Service.

Programme structure

Element	What parents should know
Six subjects	Students normally take one subject from Groups 1–5 and a sixth subject from the available school offer. The school does not directly offer Group 6 Arts.
HL and SL	The usual combination is three Higher Level and three Standard Level subjects. Four HL and two SL may be permitted.
Theory of Knowledge	TOK develops reflection on how knowledge is produced, justified and communicated.
Extended Essay	An independent research paper of up to 4,000 words, completed with supervisor guidance.
CAS	A sustained programme of creativity, activity and service experiences, including a collaborative project.
Assessment	Coursework, internal assessment and final externally marked examinations contribute to the diploma.

What the programme requires from students

- Regular attendance, sustained effort and responsible independent study.
- Strong time management across subjects, IA, EE, TOK, CAS and school commitments.
- Early communication when academic, personal or health difficulties arise.
- Academic honesty and compliance with all school and IB requirements.

What families can expect

- Clear expectations, published deadlines, feedback and regular reporting.
- Access to subject teachers, the homeroom teacher, the DP Coordinator and appropriate student-support services.
- Communication when progress, wellbeing, attendance or programme completion is at risk.

Important The DP is a partnership. The student remains responsible for their own learning, while the school and family provide structure, guidance and timely support.

2. Admissions and subject choices

At a glance Admission considers academic readiness, English proficiency, motivation, maturity and whether the school can provide a suitable subject combination and appropriate support.

Admissions process

Step	What happens
Application	The application form and recent school transcript are normally submitted by 20 February.
Entrance assessment	Applicants complete English and Mathematics tests and attend an interview, normally at the end of March.
Holistic review	The school considers grades, test evidence, motivation, effort, attendance, conduct, language readiness and programme understanding.
Subject confirmation	The proposed six-subject combination and HL/SL levels are reviewed for readiness, continuity, timetable and staffing.

Key expectations

- English proficiency is normally expected at B2–C1 CEFR. Conditional admission with a documented language-support plan may be considered exceptionally.
- Applicants are normally expected to have a first-semester average of 2.5 or better on the Slovak five-point scale, with no more than three grades of 3 and no grade of 4.
- Grades are not the only basis of admission. Readiness for independent work and a conscious choice of the DP are essential.

Subject choices

- The school cannot guarantee every requested subject or level. Choices depend on the published offer, class viability, staffing, timetable compatibility and academic readiness.
- Where a course is not taught directly, Pamoja or an externally supported language may sometimes be considered after consultation with the DP Coordinator.
- Students transferring between IB schools need continuity in official subject titles, levels, syllabus progress and completed assessment work.

First term The first term, approximately five months, is treated as a probationary period. If the student is not thriving academically or socially, the school discusses concerns and available options with the student and family.

Full document For eligibility, the detailed entrance syllabus, application documents and the current subject offer, consult the Admissions Policy and the school website.

3. Language pathways and multilingualism

At a glance English is the principal language of instruction. The school values students' home languages and promotes multilingualism, intercultural understanding and academic-language development across all subjects.

DP language pathways

Pathway	Purpose and examples
Language A	The student's strongest or near-native academic language: Slovak A: Literature SL, English A: Language and Literature SL/HL, or SSST Language A: Literature SL.
Language B	Continued acquisition for students with previous experience: English B SL/HL or German B SL.
Ab initio	A beginner course for students with little or no previous experience: Spanish ab initio SL.
Online language	Selected Language A or B courses may be available through Pamoja, subject to approval, continuity, timetable and fees.

SSST Language A

- School-Supported Self-Taught Language A: Literature is available at SL only for a strongest language not taught by the school.
- Parents arrange and pay an appropriate external tutor; the school coordinates IB requirements and monitors progress.
- SSST is academically demanding and requires sustained independence across the two-year course.

Support and responsibility

- All teachers support subject-specific vocabulary, reading, writing, speaking and comprehension through scaffolding and modelling.
- Parents can strengthen the mother tongue through reading, discussion and cultural participation without translating or producing assessed work.
- AI and translation tools may be used only when permitted. Permitted use must be transparent and acknowledged.

Slovak and graduation Students seeking recognition equivalent to the Slovak maturita must meet the applicable national requirements, including the required Slovak Language and Literature graduation components.

Course selection Language choices must provide genuine progression. Ab initio is not appropriate after substantial previous study, and Language B should not repeat a language already fully mastered.

4. Assessment, reporting and diploma requirements

At a glance IB assessment is criterion-related: students are evaluated against published subject objectives and criteria, not against their classmates.

How assessment works

Component	Purpose	Effect on results
Formative	Ongoing tasks, exercises, short quizzes, drafts and work-in-progress, discussions, self-assessment, peer assessment, feedback and reflection.	Provides students and teachers with information about current progress, strengths and areas for improvement. It guides subsequent learning and teaching and normally has no fixed direct weighting in the final IB grade.
Summative	Tests and examinations, final written assignments, essays, assessed oral tasks and other subject-specific work evaluated against predetermined criteria.	Measures the level of knowledge, understanding and skills achieved at the end of a unit or reporting period. It is one source of evidence for school grades, progress reports and Predicted Grades.
Internal Assessment (IA)	A subject-specific task, such as an oral assessment, research paper, laboratory investigation, project, portfolio or practical performance. The exact format depends on the subject.	Marked by the school teacher against IB criteria and subsequently moderated by the IB. It forms a specified percentage of the final subject grade; the applicable subject guide sets the exact weighting.
External Assessment	Final written examinations (examination papers) and, in some subjects, other externally assessed work.	Marked by the IB. In most subjects, the final written examinations form the largest part of the final subject grade; the applicable subject guide sets the exact weighting of each component.
EE and TOK	Core assessment graded A–E.	Together can add up to three core points; an E in either prevents the diploma.

Reporting and deadlines

- Semester grades and written reports are normally issued in January and June; DP2 reporting is adjusted around mock and final examinations.
- Summative tasks are normally announced in advance with the format, content, criteria and deadline.
- Students must submit IA, projects, portfolios, TOK work and the EE by the published school deadlines. Missing required work can put the diploma at risk.
- Parents can follow progress through official reports, ManageBac, parent meetings and communication with teachers or the DP Coordinator.

Predicted Grades

- A Predicted Grade is the teacher's professional estimate of the final IB grade, based on the available body of evidence. It is not added to the final score.
- Universities may use predicted grades for admissions or conditional offers.

Final subject grade Each subject guide defines its own components and weightings. The official grade from 7 to 1 is based on the weighted total and the IB grade boundaries for that examination session.

Diploma award and academic progress

At a glance A total of 24 points is necessary, but it is not sufficient on its own. Every diploma condition and all required components must be satisfied.

Essential diploma conditions

- At least 24 points overall, including any TOK/EE core points.
- CAS requirements completed.
- No grade 1; no more than two grade 2s; no more than three grade 3s.
- At least 12 points in HL subjects and at least 9 points in SL subjects, subject to the applicable rule for four HL or two SL subjects.
- No grade E in TOK or the Extended Essay and no N (no grade) in a required component.
- No diploma-preventing penalty for academic misconduct.

When a student is struggling

- The student should seek help early, use feedback, attend agreed support sessions and follow an improvement plan where required.
- If an end-of-DP1 subject grade is 1 or 2, the school meets with the student and family to review the reasons and agree next steps.
- Options may include structured summer work, reassessment, repeating DP1 or progression with enhanced support and monitoring.
- Progression to DP2 does not guarantee success in the final examinations or the award of the diploma.

How parents can support progress

- Monitor deadlines and routines without taking control of the student's work.
- Encourage sleep, realistic planning and early communication rather than last-minute intervention.
- Discuss feedback and improvement targets, and contact the subject teacher promptly when a difficulty is subject-specific.

Full document For grading, reassessment, reporting, complaints and detailed procedures, consult the Assessment Policy and Parent Guide to Assessment.

5. Academic integrity, AI and examinations

At a glance Authentic work reflects the student's own ideas, language, understanding and effort. Every source and permitted form of assistance must be acknowledged appropriately.

Common forms of misconduct

Type	Examples
Plagiarism	Using words, ideas, images or data without proper acknowledgement.
Collusion	Allowing work to be copied or helping another student gain an unfair advantage.
Unauthorized assistance	Another person, tutor, translator or tool produces or excessively edits assessed work.
Fabrication or falsification	Inventing data, changing evidence or providing false records, including CAS documentation.
Duplication	Submitting substantially the same work for more than one assessment.
Examination misconduct	Using prohibited materials or communication, disrupting an exam or sharing protected content.

Artificial intelligence and translation tools

- Tools may be used only when the teacher or task permits them.
- Any permitted AI-generated or AI-assisted content must be acknowledged and referenced.
- Students remain responsible for accuracy, bias, source checking and demonstrating their own understanding.
- Unacknowledged AI-generated content is treated as academic misconduct.

If misconduct is suspected

- The student is informed of the concern, given an opportunity to explain and the available evidence is reviewed fairly.
- Consequences may include a zero, resubmission where appropriate, parent notification, probation or further disciplinary action.
- Cases involving work submitted to the IB or IB examinations follow IB investigation procedures and may affect a component, subject or diploma award.

Best protection Students should keep drafts and research notes, cite as they work, ask before using a tool and be able to explain how every part of the submitted work was produced.

6. Inclusion, access arrangements and wellbeing

At a glance The school seeks equitable access to learning and assessment while maintaining the objectives, criteria and academic rigor of the Diploma Programme.

How support is organized

Stage	What happens
Referral	A teacher, parent or student identifies a learning, language, medical, emotional or access need.
Assessment	The school gathers observations, student voice, school evidence and relevant professional documentation.
Planning	An IEP, LSP or other support plan records goals, strategies, accommodations, responsibilities and review dates where needed.
Review	Progress and wellbeing are monitored and support is adjusted when evidence or circumstances change.

Inclusive access arrangements

- Possible arrangements include extra time, modified formats, assistive technology, a reader or scribe, when permitted and justified under current IB regulations.
- Arrangements must reflect the student's usual way of working and require appropriate educational or medical evidence.
- Requests requiring IB authorization must be prepared well in advance; families should contact the DP Coordinator as early as possible.

Student wellbeing

- Academic, emotional and social wellbeing are considered together. Students are encouraged to seek support before difficulties become a crisis.
- The homeroom teacher is normally the first contact; the DP Coordinator, school psychologist, subject teachers and other support staff contribute as needed.
- Sensitive information is shared only with authorized staff who need it to support the student.

Family responsibilities

- Provide accurate and current educational, psychological or medical information.
- Participate in planning and review meetings and communicate changes promptly.
- Support agreed strategies while respecting the student's agency and privacy.

Accessibility The school operates in a historic building with physical-access limitations. Families should discuss mobility and building-access needs before admission or as soon as circumstances change.

7. TOK, Extended Essay, CAS and key deadlines

At a glance The DP core is compulsory. It develops reflection, independent research, personal growth and responsible engagement beyond individual subject courses.

Core responsibilities

Core element	Student responsibility	Family support
TOK	Attend, participate, develop the required exhibition and essay work, and meet internal checkpoints.	Discuss ideas and time planning without producing or editing assessed work.
Extended Essay	Choose a viable topic, meet the supervisor, research independently, keep records and submit each stage on time.	Encourage a steady routine and early communication when progress stops.
CAS	Plan, participate, reflect, maintain evidence and complete the required collaborative project.	Support safe, meaningful participation while leaving ownership with the student.

Managing DP deadlines

- The school publishes a deadline calendar covering IA, EE, TOK, CAS, mock examinations, reports and final examinations.
- Students should record deadlines in one personal system and work backwards through smaller checkpoints.
- School internal deadlines are earlier than IB submission dates so that authentication, feedback, administration and technical checks can be completed.
- A deadline problem should be communicated before the deadline. Extensions are exceptional and require approval under the applicable procedure.

A practical monthly check

- Which major deadline is next, and what smaller step must be completed this week?
- Is progress in all six subjects, TOK, EE and CAS visible in ManageBac or the agreed school system?
- Are workload, sleep, attendance or wellbeing beginning to affect performance?
- Does the student need support from a teacher, supervisor, coordinator or psychologist?

Current dates Always use the latest school calendar and official messages. Dates shown in older guides, screenshots or personal notes may no longer be current.

8. Communication, support and useful contacts

At a glance Questions are resolved most effectively when they are directed first to the person closest to the issue and raised early, clearly and respectfully.

Who to contact

Question or concern	First contact
A task, criterion, feedback or subject grade	Subject teacher
Attendance, class situation, social concern or general daily support	Homeroom teacher
Several subjects, subject combination, DP rules, transfer or formal IB process	DP Coordinator
TOK, Extended Essay or CAS	Relevant core teacher/coordinator; DP Coordinator where programme-wide
Emotional or mental-health concern	Homeroom teacher or school psychologist; urgent concerns should be communicated immediately
University planning and applications	University/Career Counsellor
Formal complaint or appeal	Follow the relevant school policy and published procedure

Communication principles

- Include the student in age-appropriate communication and encourage them to speak for themselves where possible.
- Provide specific information: the subject, task, date, concern and support already requested.
- Allow the relevant teacher or coordinator to review evidence before expecting a conclusion.
- Use official school channels and protect the confidentiality of other students.

Useful information

Resource	Where to look
Full school policies and admission information	School website: www.gymnaziumceska.sk
DP deadlines, progress and programme communication	ManageBac and current school communications
Programme-wide questions	DP office: ib@gymnaziumceska.sk
Official IB regulations	Current IB publications communicated through the school

Final reminder This handbook is intentionally concise. When a situation requires an exact rule, deadline, evidence standard or appeal route, the current full policy and official IB documentation take precedence.

9. Complaints procedure

At a glance A concern should normally be raised first with the person closest to the issue. If it is not resolved informally, a student, parent or legal guardian may submit a formal written complaint.

Steps and expected timelines

Stage	What to do	Timeline
1. Informal resolution	Raise the concern directly with the relevant teacher or staff member.	Normally within 1–2 working days
2. Formal complaint	Send the completed form or an equivalent written message to ib@gymnaziumceska.sk . Include the issue, relevant evidence and the requested outcome.	Receipt acknowledged on the day received
3. Investigation	A designated staff member reviews the evidence and may speak with the people involved.	Normally within 2–3 working days
4. Written outcome	The school communicates its findings, decision and any actions in writing.	After the investigation
5. Appeal	If dissatisfied, submit a written appeal. A different staff member or panel reviews the decision.	Within 3 working days of the decision

What a formal complaint should contain

- The complainant's name, role and contact details.
- A clear description of the concern, including relevant dates, events and people involved.
- Copies of relevant documents, messages or other supporting evidence.
- The outcome or resolution being requested.

Principles

- Fairness and impartiality; confidentiality; timely handling; the right of all parties to be heard; and protection from retaliation.
- Information is shared only with staff who need it to review and resolve the matter. Records are retained securely under school procedures.

Important The complete process is normally concluded within 5–8 working days. Exceptional extensions may be necessary; the complainant will be informed of the reason and revised timeframe.

Appeal An appeal is not simply a repeated complaint. It should explain why the original decision may have been unfair, inconsistent or based on incomplete information, and should identify any new or overlooked evidence.

Complaint Form

At a glance Use this form to submit a formal complaint about a school decision, service, programme matter or staff conduct. An equivalent email containing all fields below is also acceptable.

1. Complainant information

Name	Role	Contact email / phone
	Student / Parent / Legal guardian / Other	

2. Date of the issue

Date

3. Details of the complaint

Describe the issue clearly, including relevant dates, events, decisions and people involved.

Your description

4. Supporting evidence

List and attach relevant documents, emails, assessment evidence or other records.

Evidence attached

5. Desired outcome or resolution

What would you like the school to do?

6. Declaration

I confirm that the information provided is accurate to the best of my knowledge.

Signature	Date

Submit: Send the completed form and attachments to ib@gymnaziumceska.sk and keep a copy for your records.

This section explains the information that a complaint should contain. The complaint form is available in the separate document *Procedure for Submitting Complaints by Parents/Legal Guardians and Students*.

10. IB Jargon Buster

At a glance A quick guide to frequently used IB terms and abbreviations. Subject-specific terminology is explained by the relevant teacher or subject guide.

Programme and assessment terms

Term	Meaning	Term	Meaning
DP	Diploma Programme: the two-year IB programme for students aged 16–19.	HL / SL	Higher Level / Standard Level; the two levels at which DP subjects are studied.
IB / IBO	International Baccalaureate / International Baccalaureate Organization.	DP core	The compulsory combination of TOK, EE and CAS.
TOK	Theory of Knowledge: reflection on how knowledge is produced and justified.	EE	Extended Essay: an independent research paper of up to 4,000 words.
CAS	Creativity, Activity, Service: experiential learning completed throughout the DP.	IA	Internal Assessment: assessed work marked by the teacher and moderated by the IB.
EA	External Assessment: work marked directly by IB examiners, including final papers.	PG	Predicted Grade: the teacher's evidence-based estimate of a likely final IB grade.
Mock exams	School practice examinations held before the final IB examination session.	Moderation	IB checking of teacher marking to ensure a common international standard.
Authentication	Confirmation that submitted work is the student's own and sources are acknowledged.	Grade boundary	The mark range established for each final subject grade from 7 to 1.
ManageBac	The school's main platform for DP deadlines, coursework, CAS and programme communication.	ATL	Approaches to Learning: thinking, communication, social, self-management and research skills.
SSST	School-Supported Self-Taught Language A: Literature, offered at SL.	Pamoja	An IB-linked provider of selected online DP courses; participation requires school approval.
CEFR	Common European Framework of Reference for Languages, with levels from A1 to C2.	Access arrangements	Authorized adjustments that remove barriers without changing assessment standards.
IEP / LSP	Individual Education Plan / Language Support Plan recording agreed support.	PSP 2020	Programme standards and practices: the framework used to develop and evaluate IB programmes.
Self-study	The school community's evidence-based review of how well the programme meets IB expectations.	Evaluation visit	An IB review visit that verifies programme implementation and supports development.

Tip When an abbreviation is unfamiliar, ask for clarification. Parents are not expected to learn IB terminology before they can participate meaningfully in their child's education.

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